

2026 ESL Volunteer Cost Report

Independent research from ESLVolunteerFinder.com · No paid placements · Updated May 2026

Thanks for subscribing. Here's the full breakdown of what it costs to volunteer-teach English abroad in 2026 — weekly fees, application costs, housing, meals, and 4-week budget estimates for 11 programs across 5 countries.

ALL 11 PROGRAMS AT A GLANCE

Weekly fees and application costs as listed on provider sites. Housing is included in every program below. Meals vary. All 11 listings verified against provider sites in April 2026.

Country	Provider	Program	Weekly	App fee	Meals
Vietnam	IVHQ	ESL Vietnam — Ho Chi Minh City	\$190	\$249	Yes
Vietnam	GVI	Community Teaching — Hoi An	\$320	—	Yes
Vietnam	Love Volunteers	Teach English in Vietnam	\$175	\$279	Yes
Thailand	IVHQ	ESL Thailand — Chiang Mai	\$180	\$249	Yes
Thailand	IVHQ	ESL Thailand — Hua Hin	\$263	\$249	Yes
Nepal	IVHQ	ESL Nepal — Kathmandu	\$160	\$249	Yes
Nepal	Love Volunteers	Teach English in Nepal	\$155	\$279	Yes
Ghana	IVHQ	ESL Ghana — Accra	\$195	\$249	—
Ghana	World Volunteers	Teach English in Ghana	\$145	\$195	—
Peru	IVHQ	ESL Peru — Cusco	\$205	\$249	—
Peru	Projects Abroad	Teaching in Peru	\$420	—	—

"—" = not included or not separately disclosed by the provider.

WHAT PROGRAM FEES USUALLY COVER

Included in most programs: in-country coordinator, airport pickup, orientation, school placement, shared housing, 24/7 support.

Not included anywhere: flights, travel insurance, visa fees, personal spending money, weekend excursions.

Real-world 4-week budgets

Worked examples using the cheapest program in each country. Includes program fee, application fee, and food/spending. Flights are shown separately.

PERSONAL SPENDING MONEY BY COUNTRY

Country	Per week	Notes
Vietnam	\$60–\$90/wk	Meals are included in all programs. Main spend: weekend travel, SIM card, entry fees.
Thailand	\$60–\$90/wk	Meals usually included. Main spend: weekend travel, SIM card, entry fees.
Nepal	\$50–\$80/wk	Meals usually included. Cheapest country in the dataset.
Ghana	\$60–\$90/wk	Meals not always included. Local food is affordable (\$2–4/meal).
Peru	\$80–\$120/wk	Cusco is a tourist hub — restaurant prices higher than Southeast Asia.

4-WEEK COST — CHEAPEST PROGRAM IN EACH COUNTRY

Program	Program fee	App	Spending	In-country	+ Flights
Nepal — Love Volunteers Nepal	\$620	\$279	\$260	\$1,159	\$900–1,400
Ghana — World Volunteers Ghana	\$580	\$195	\$360	\$1,135	\$900–1,500
Thailand — IVHQ Thailand (Chiang Mai)	\$720	\$249	\$280	\$1,249	\$700–1,200
Vietnam — Love Volunteers Vietnam	\$700	\$279	\$280	\$1,259	\$700–1,200
Peru — IVHQ Peru (Cusco)	\$820	\$249	\$400	\$1,469	\$600–1,100

BUDGET SUMMARY BY DESTINATION

MOST AFFORDABLE \$1,200–\$1,600 4 weeks in-country, cheapest program Nepal, Ghana	MID-RANGE \$1,500–\$2,000 4 weeks in-country, cheapest program Vietnam, Thailand	HIGHER COST \$1,800–\$2,400 4 weeks in-country, cheapest program Peru (Cusco)
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All figures exclude flights, visa, and travel insurance. Add \$600–\$1,500 for round-trip flights depending on departure city.

Prices change frequently. Verify directly with providers before applying.

NEXT STEPS

Pick your country at eslvolunteerfinder.com/countries

Or run your own numbers at eslvolunteerfinder.com/cost-guide

